



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

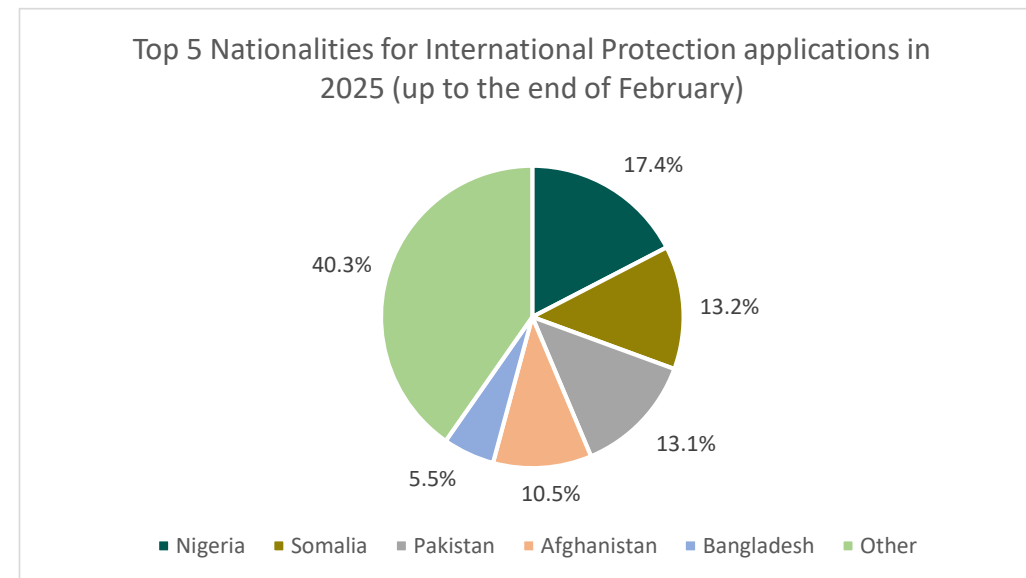
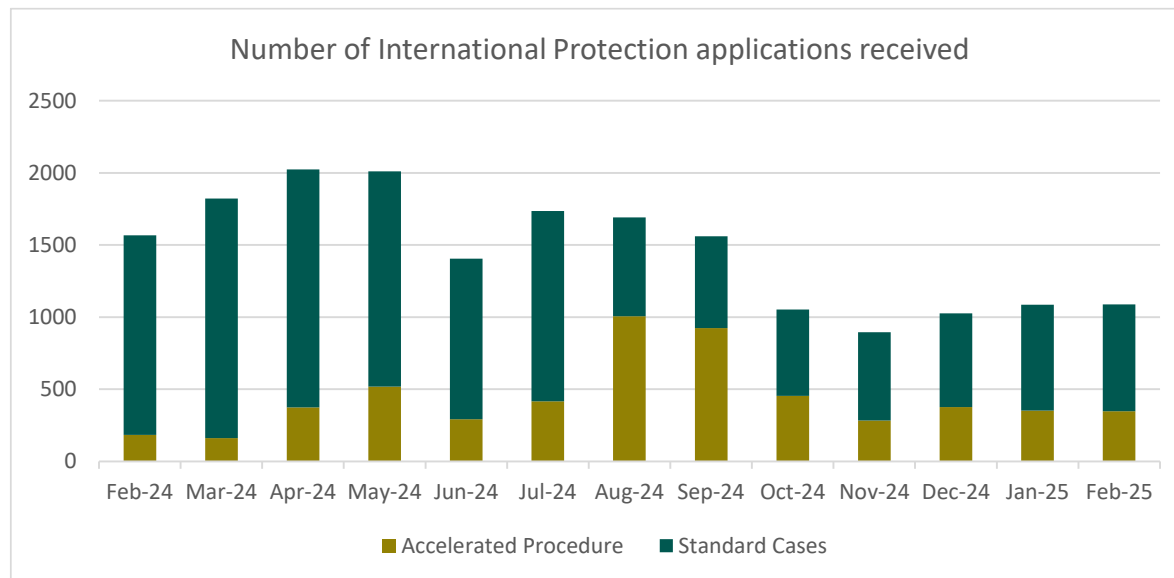
International Protection: February 2025

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 6th March 2025. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for February 2025:

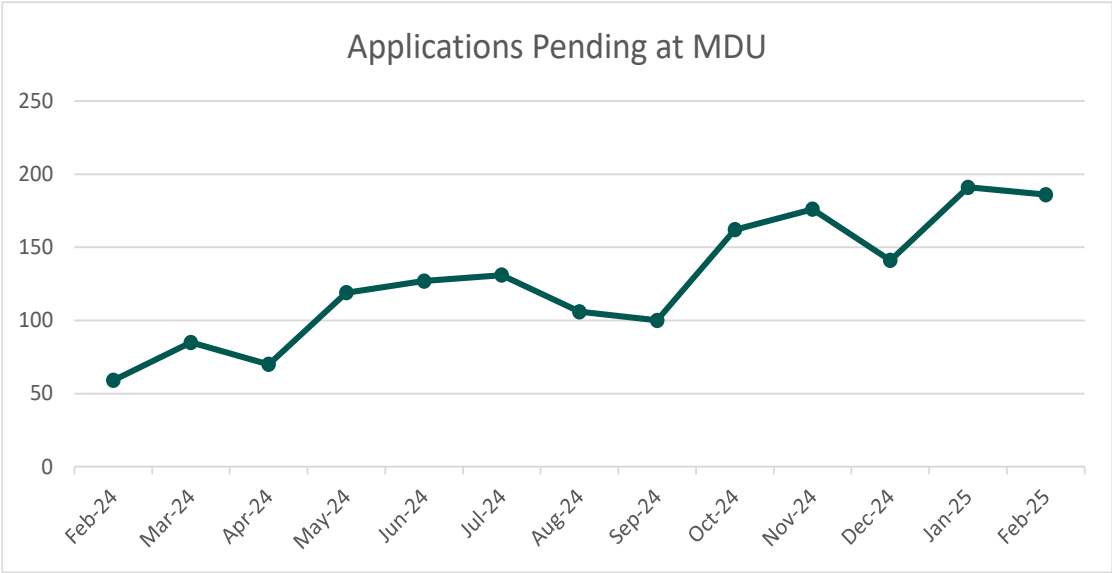
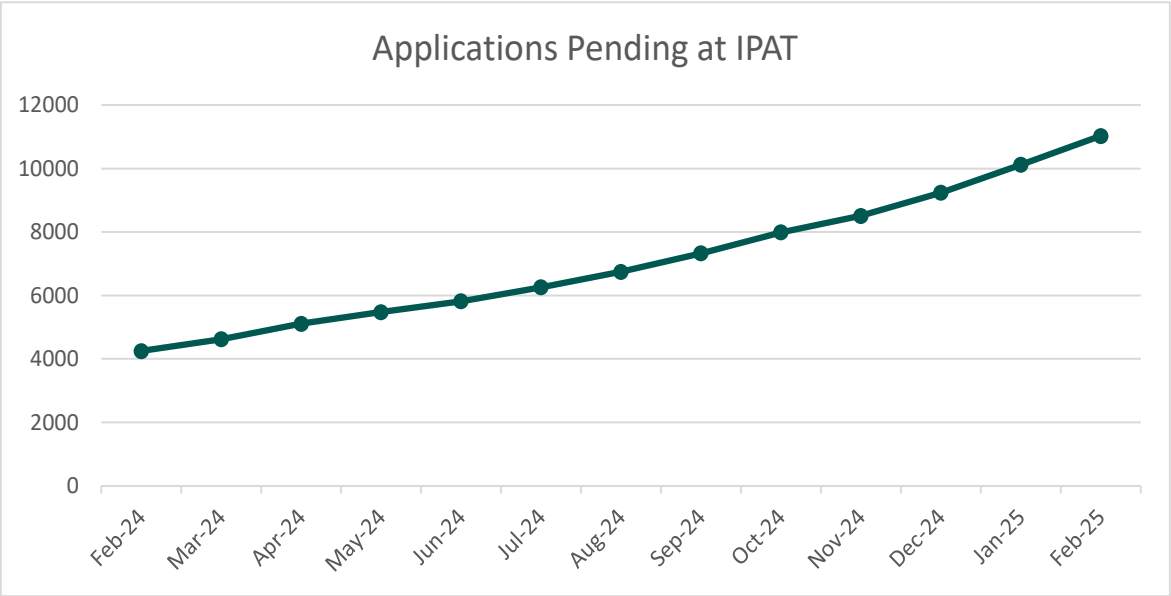
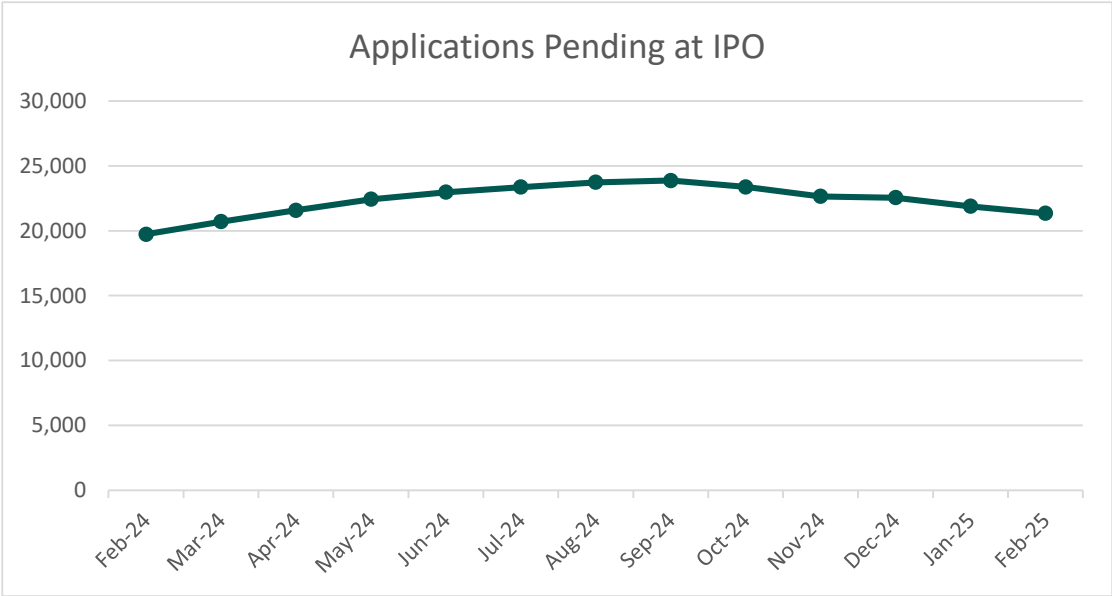
- The number of asylum applications is remaining constant. In February 2025 there were 1,088 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,567 last February
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (378 applications), Somalia (287), Pakistan (284), Afghanistan (229) and Bangladesh (120)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO is continuing to reduce slowly since October 2024. As of February this year there were 21,343 applications pending
- The number of applications in the IPO where a recommendation has been made or otherwise closed off has decreased in February 2025, where 1,621 cases were closed off
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has begun to trend downwards. In February 2025 the median processing time to determination was 74 weeks (compared to 75 weeks in August 2024 and 81 weeks in November 2024)
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 599 at the end of February 2025
- Of those applications where a decision was made in February 2025 by MDU, 56% of decisions were refusals, 7% permission to remain, and 37% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



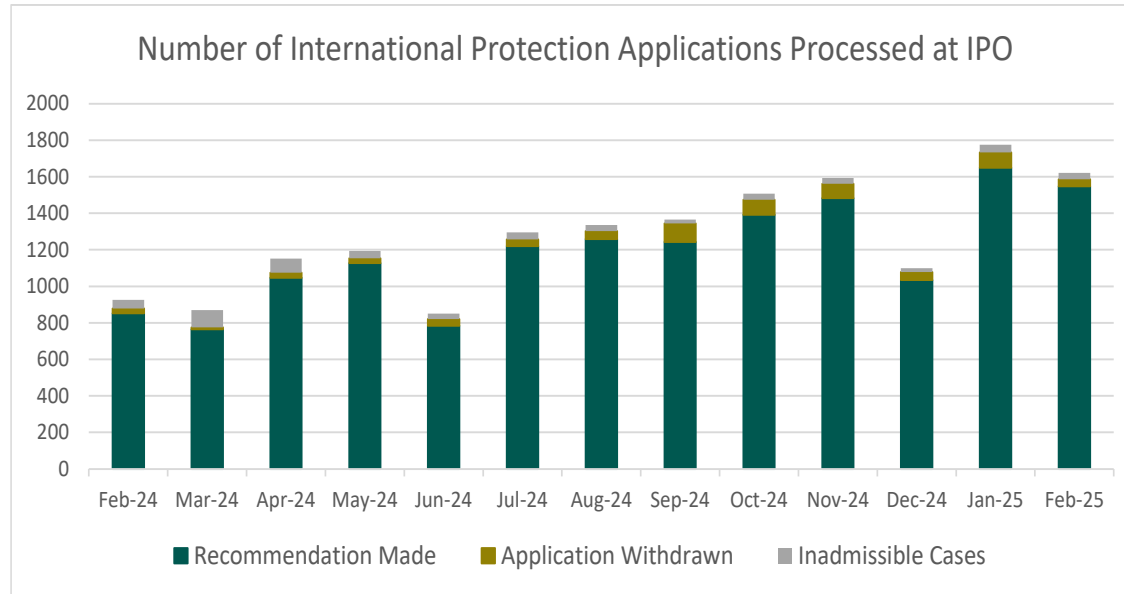
- In February there were 1,088 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,567 last February. The average number of applications per month between March 2024 and February 2025 was 1,449
- The total number of applications in February 2025 that fell under accelerated procedure was 347 (which represents 32% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (378 applications), Somalia (287), Pakistan (284), Afghanistan (229) and Bangladesh (120)

Pending International Protection Applications

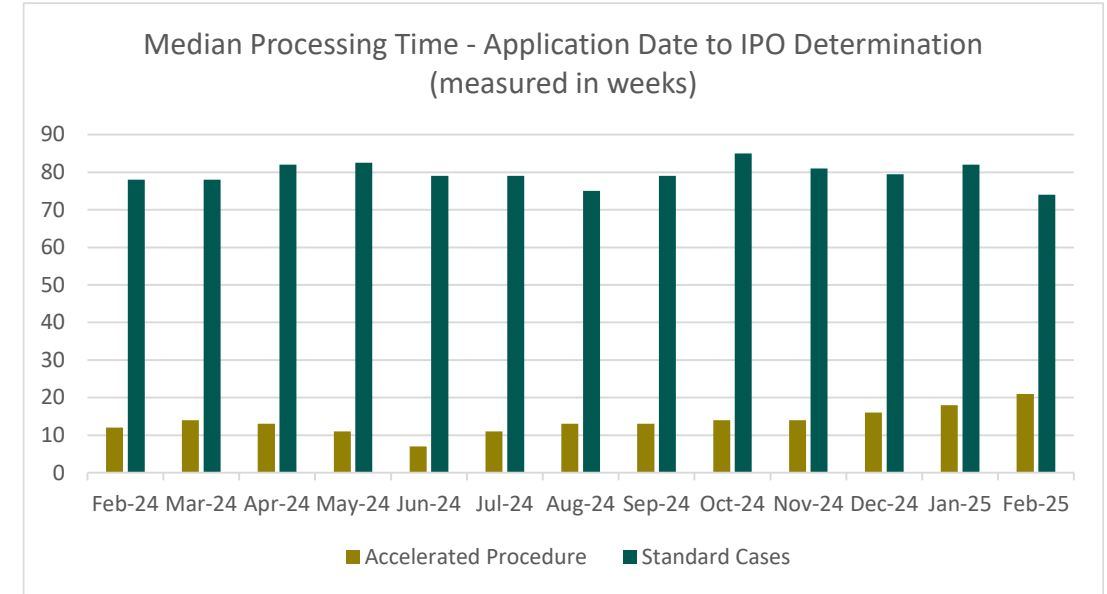


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 21,343. The numbers have begun to reduce since October 2024 (23,373)
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In February 2025, there were 11,031 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of February 2025 is 186

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

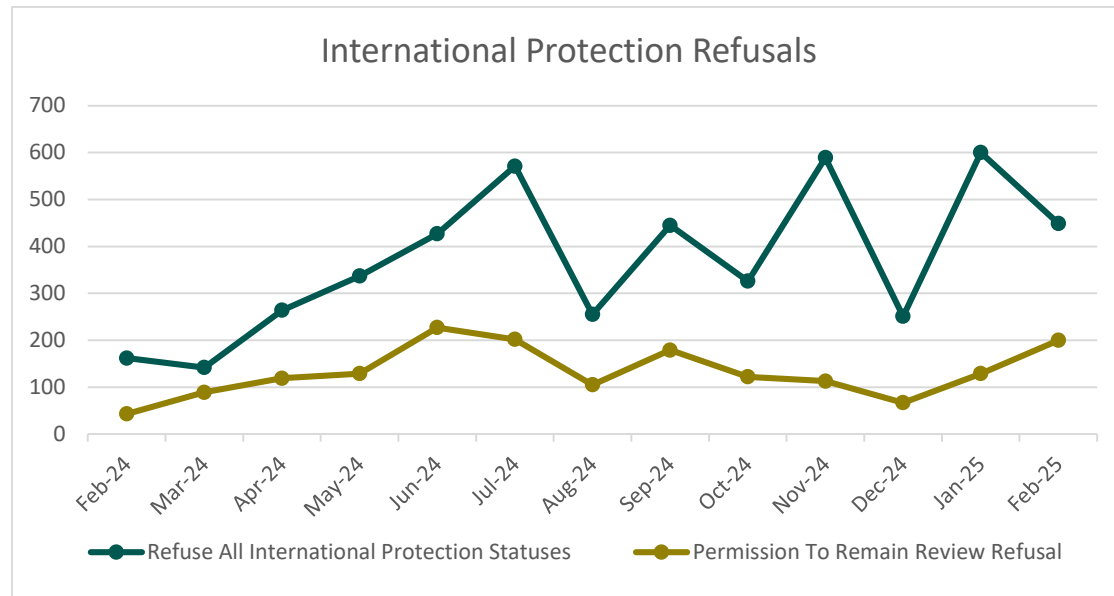
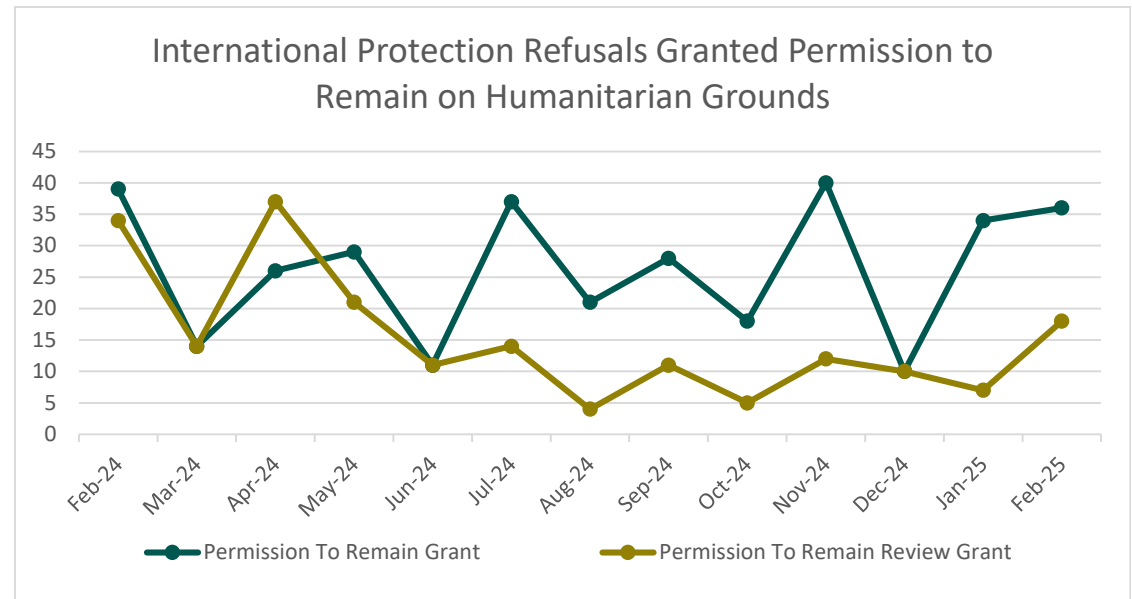
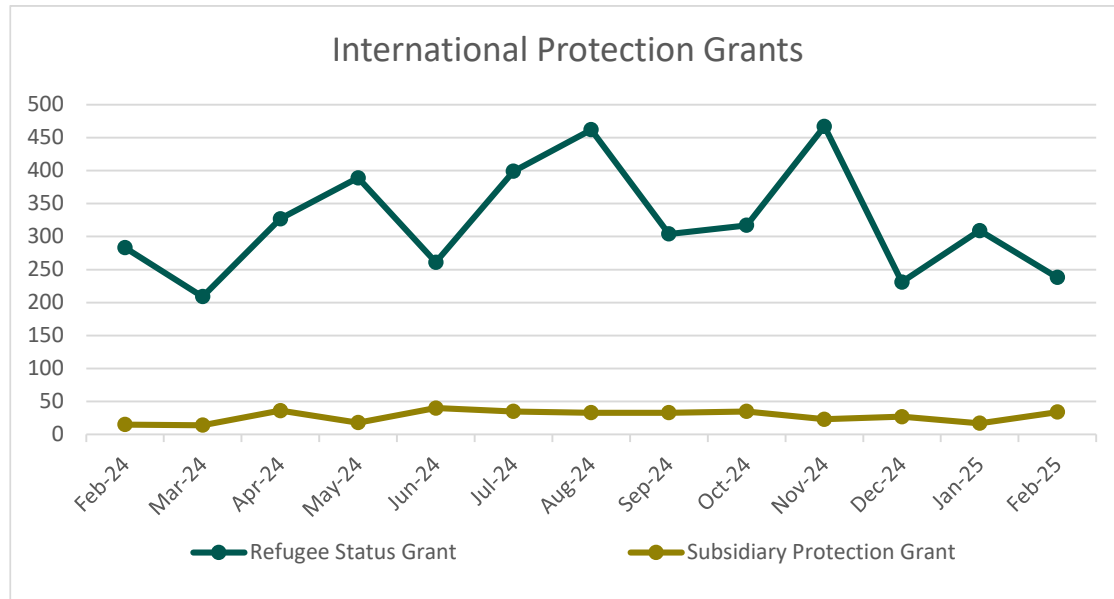


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In February 2025, 1,621 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,100 in December 2024 and down from 1,776 in January 2025
- 2025 YTD applications processed were 3,397 (an 88.4% increase on 1,803 applications processed for 2024 YTD)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly decreasing since October 2024 for Standard Cases and slowly increasing for cases under the Accelerated Procedure
- In February 2025, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 74 weeks (down from 79.5 weeks for December 2024 and 82 weeks for January 2025)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 21 weeks in February 2025, up from 16 weeks in December 2024 and 18 weeks in January 2025

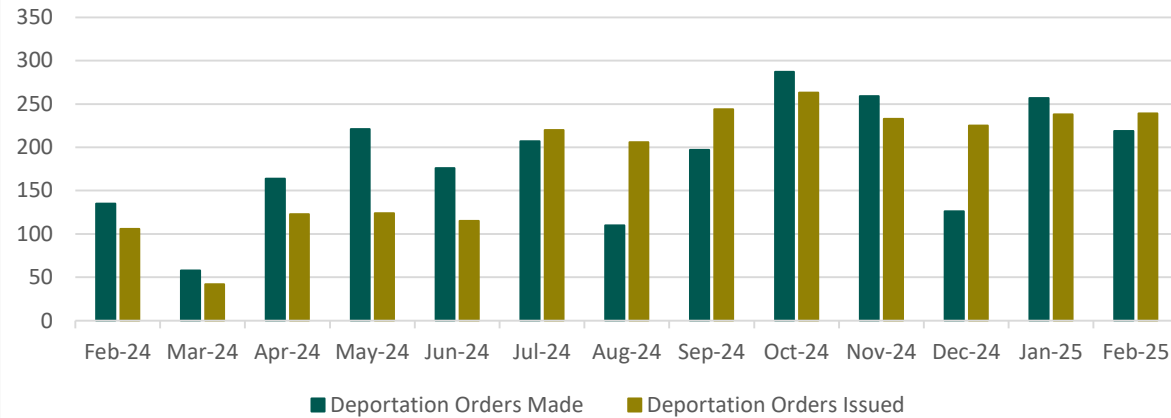
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In February 2025, of those applications where a decision was made, 238 were given refugee status grant and 34 subsidiary protection grant (272 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 36 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 18 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 449 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 200 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for February 2025, 56% of decisions were refusals, 7% permission to remain, and 37% were international protection grants

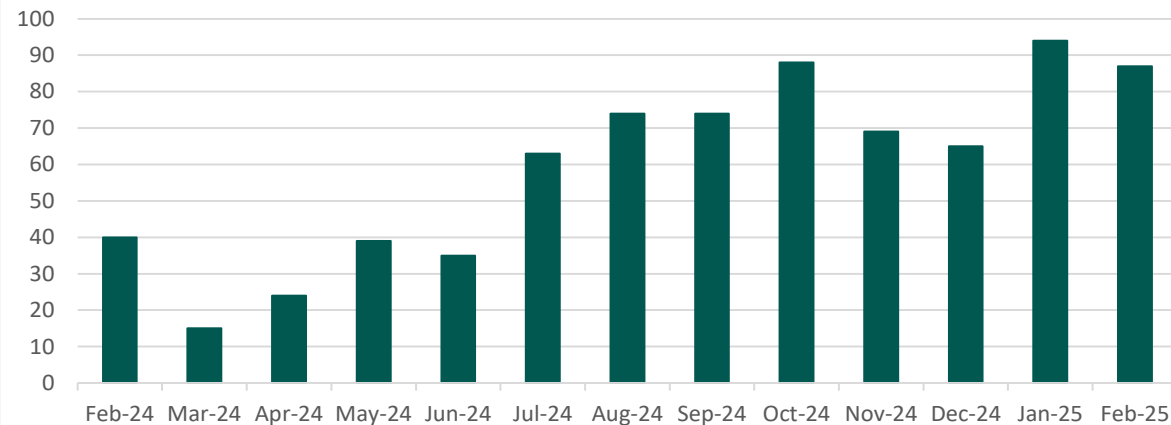
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

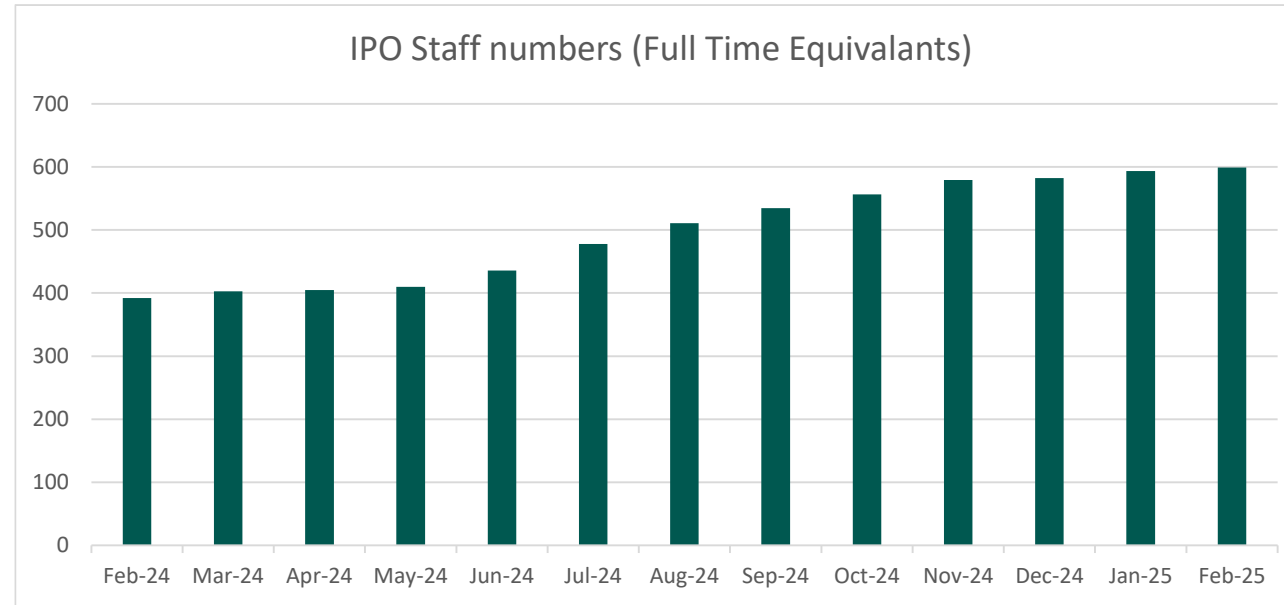


- For February 2025 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 219 and the number of deportation orders issued was 239. For January 2025, the figures were 257 and 238, and for December 2024, it was 126 and 225, respectively
- For February 2025 the number of removals was 87

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing
- In February 2024 there were 392 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 511 in August 2024 and 579 in November 2024
- At the end of February 2025, the IPO had 599 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

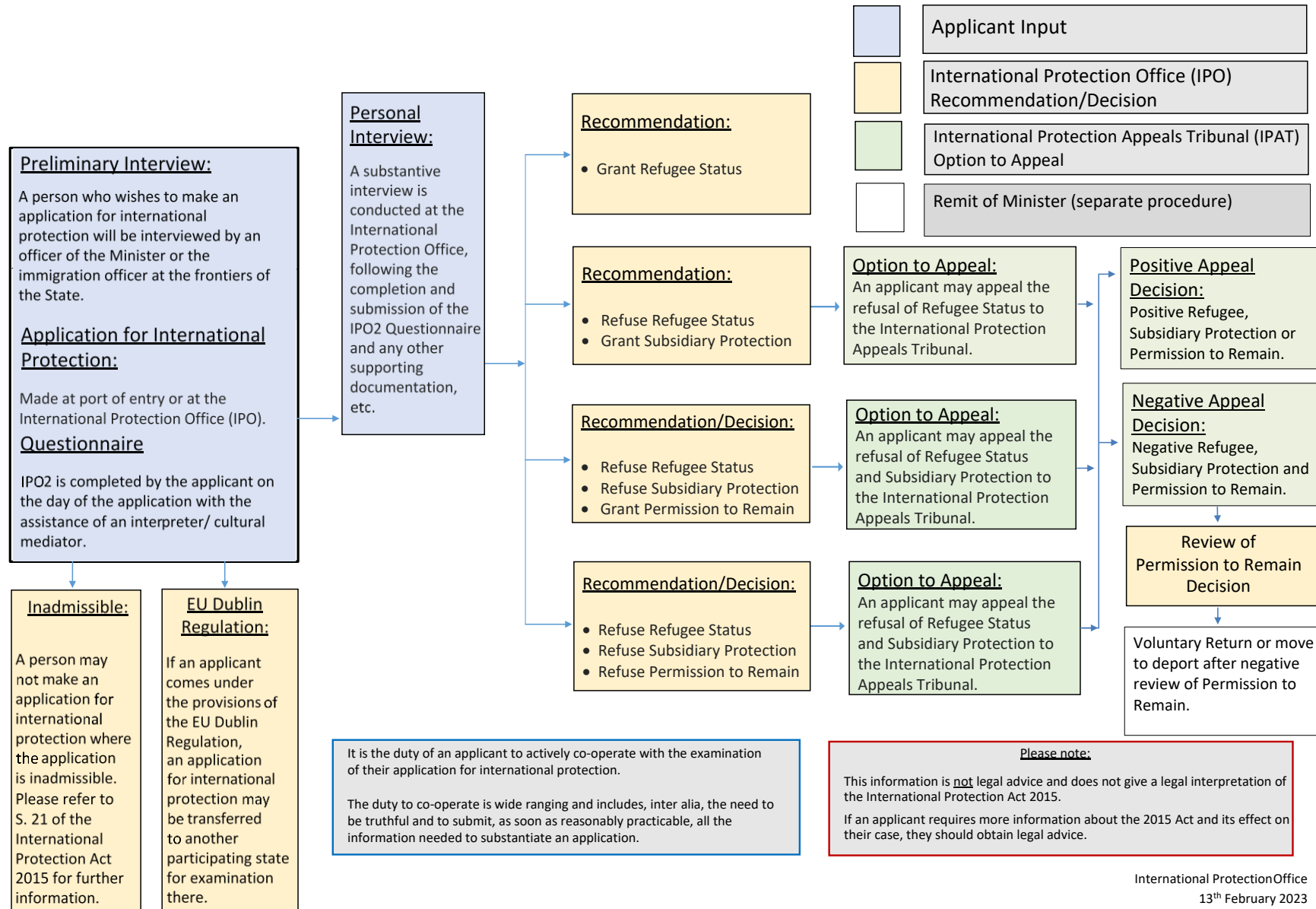
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
Accelerated Procedure	183	162	374	518	292	417	1005	923	453	282	377	352	347
Standard Cases	1384	1659	1649	1492	1112	1318	687	637	599	614	648	734	741

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	378	17.4%
Somalia	287	13.2%
Pakistan	284	13.1%
Afghanistan	229	10.5%
Bangladesh	120	5.5%
Other	876	40.3%
Total	2174	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
IPO Pending	19,719	20,695	21,577	22,419	22,965	23,360	23,727	23,863	23,373	22,641	22,548	21,882	21,343

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
IPAT Pending	4251	4620	5110	5478	5821	6257	6748	7331	7990	8513	9243	10125	11031

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
MDU Pending	59	85	70	119	127	131	106	100	162	176	141	191	186

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
Recommendation Made	853	765	1047	1128	784	1220	1259	1243	1391	1482	1035	1650	1548
Application Withdrawn	25	10	28	25	36	36	44	101	83	80	43	84	38
Inadmissible Cases	48	95	77	40	30	40	32	21	33	31	22	42	35

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
Accelerated Procedure	12	14	13	11	7	11	13	13	14	14	16	18	21
Standard Cases	78	78	82	82.5	79	79	75	79	85	81	79.5	82	74

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
Refugee Status Grant	283	209	327	389	261	399	462	304	317	467	231	309	238
Subsidiary Protection Grant	15	14	36	18	40	35	33	33	35	23	27	17	34
Permission to Remain Grant	39	14	26	29	11	37	21	28	18	40	10	34	36
Permission to Remain Review Grant	34	14	37	21	11	14	4	11	5	12	10	7	18

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	162	142	264	337	427	571	255	445	326	589	251	600	449
Permission to Remain Refusal	43	89	119	129	227	202	105	179	122	113	67	129	200

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
Deportation Orders Made	135	58	164	221	176	207	110	197	287	259	126	257	219
Deportation Orders Issued	106	42	123	124	115	220	206	244	263	233	225	238	239

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
Enforcements/Returns	40	15	24	39	35	63	74	74	88	69	65	94	87

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25
IPO Staffing Level	392.1	402.85	404.85	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7	534.3	556.3	579.1	582.1	593.4	598.8